SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #15 · HOLY SPIRIT

“My spiritual gifts don’t matter as much as other people’s.”

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Where it often comes from

A church culture that celebrated only up-front gifts like preaching, singing, or leading. Being overlooked or compared with a more talented sibling or friend. Quiet personality or behind-the-scenes service that rarely gets thanked. Low self-esteem that dismisses anything you do well. Thinking that a gift must be dramatic to be important.

What Scripture teaches

Every believer receives gifts from the Spirit for the good of the whole body. God Himself placed each member where He wanted. Paul says the parts that seem weaker are actually indispensable. A kind word, a meal, a prayer, a faithful act of service: these are the manifold grace of God at work. Your gift is not a smaller version of someone else’s; it is the one God chose for you.

> *“But in fact, God has arranged the members of the body, every one of them, according to His design”* **(1 Corinthians 12:18)**.

Also see

> “The eye cannot say to the hand, ‘I do not need you.’ Nor can the head say to the feet, ‘I do not need you.’ On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable” **(1 Corinthians 12:21–22)**.

> “Now to each one the manifestation of the Spirit is given for the common good” **(1 Corinthians 12:7)**.

> “As good stewards of the manifold grace of God, each of you should use whatever gift he has received to serve one another” **(1 Peter 4:10)**.

> “We have different gifts according to the grace given us. If one’s gift is prophecy, let him use it in proportion to his faith” **(Romans 12:6)**.

Common self-statements

- What I do doesn’t really count.
- God uses other people, not me.
- I don’t have any real gifts.
- Nobody would miss what I do.
- I’m just a background person.
- If I were more gifted, I’d matter more.

Common logical errors

- **Comparison:** Measuring your gift against someone else’s instead of against God’s design.
- **Minimization:** Shrinking the value of quiet or hidden service.
- **Labeling:** Calling yourself “ungifted” or “unimportant.”
- **Disqualifying the positive:** Dismissing thanks or evidence that God has used you.
- **Should statements:** “I should have a more impressive gift.”

Challenging questions

- Who decided where I fit in the body of Christ?
- What does Paul say about the parts that seem weaker?
- If the Spirit gives gifts to each one, what has He given me?
- Has my quiet service ever made a difference in someone's life?
- Am I valuing gifts the way the world does, or the way God does?
- Would the church be better off if everyone had the same gift?
- Who in my church shows that hidden gifts matter?

Truth summary

> My spiritual gifts matter. God gave them to me on purpose, for the good of others. He arranged the body exactly as He wanted, and the parts that seem weaker are indispensable. I do not need to compare myself with anyone; I need to be a faithful steward of the grace God has given me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Gifts, Spiritual
- Servant
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Church
- Humility

Listen: Overcoming Depression

Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My spiritual gifts don't matter as much as other people's"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My spiritual gifts don't matter as much as other people's." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who decided where I fit in Christ's body?
- ☐ What does Paul say about the "weaker" parts?
- ☐ What has the Spirit given me?
- ☐ Has my quiet service made a difference?
- ☐ Am I valuing gifts the way God does?
- ☐ Would the church be better if everyone were the same?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God placed me in His body on purpose.
- ☐ My gifts are given for the good of others.
- ☐ The parts that seem weaker are indispensable.
- ☐ I am a steward of God's grace.
- ☐ I do not need to compare my gift with anyone's.
- ☐ Small acts of service matter to God.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **1 Corinthians 12:18**
  "But in fact, God has arranged the members of the body, every one of them, according to His design."
- [ ] **1 Corinthians 12:21–22**
  "The eye cannot say to the hand, 'I do not need you.' Nor can the head say to the feet, 'I do not need you.' On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable."
- [ ] **1 Corinthians 12:7**
  "Now to each one the manifestation of the Spirit is given for the common good."
- [ ] **1 Peter 4:10**
  "As good stewards of the manifold grace of God, each of you should use whatever gift he has received to serve one another."
- [ ] **Romans 12:6**
  "We have different gifts according to the grace given us. If one's gift is prophecy, let him use it in proportion to his faith."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Gift log:** Each day, write one way God used me to help, encourage, or serve someone, no matter how small.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, 1 Peter 4:10 becomes: "As a good steward of the manifold grace of God, **Sarah** should use whatever gift **she** has received to serve one another."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Gifts, Spiritual" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Ask three people:** "What do you think God has gifted me to do?" Write down every answer.
- ☐ **Use one gift on purpose this week,** such as encouraging, helping, giving, or praying, and notice the effect.
- ☐ **Write a thank-you note** to someone whose hidden service you appreciate, and notice how much it matters.
- ☐ **Read 1 Corinthians 12:12–27** and write which part of the body you are most like.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My spiritual gifts don't matter as much as other people's": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One way God used me today
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My spiritual gifts don't matter as much as other people's.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Holy Spirit, thank You for the gifts You have given me. Help me reject the lie that my gifts don't matter as much as other people's. Free me from comparison, and help me use what You have given me faithfully and joyfully to serve others. Thank You for placing me in Your body. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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